

Tobias Treppmann

Design systems shaped by how the organization actually works

CONTACT

LOCATION

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems

DTCG design tokens · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma variables and live library sync · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · design systems built to stay intact under AI-assisted work · governance and contribution paths · motion carried as shared easing curves

Interaction and visual design

Data-dense analytical interfaces · honest feedback for sampled and approximate data · availability and booking logic shaped by progressive disclosure and error prevention · color in OKLCH with contrast held in light and dark mode · theming across iOS, Android, web and connected TV · Selah, a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store, down to the icon and the store listing

Accessibility

an accessibility audit under the European Accessibility Act · WCAG contrast checked in code · screen-reader semantics and ARIA · alt text generated at platform scale, across six countries

Building and tools

Prototyping in real code against production APIs · Android and Kotlin · SwiftUI · React and web · Claude Code and Zed as daily tools · Storybook and component specifications engineering can build from without a Figma seat

Governance and strategy

Tools, governance and workflows · integrating new technology into how a team works · design strategy tied to business and product goals · change management across functions · mentoring designers outside a reporting line

PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, where I built the design system from scratch — a four-tier token architecture made to serve iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source. Nobody who builds with it reports to me. Engineering sits at external agencies and product managers set direction, so the system has to enforce itself. An enumerated token vocabulary makes the compliant path the fast one for a product manager and for an AI assistant alike. The build rejects what does not come from it. I owned the design system at Ninox and defined component architecture at Datameer before that.

Enforced in the build

checks in CI refuse a token reference that does not resolve, or a color written straight into a component

Accessibility in code

WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm, and an EU Accessibility Act audit that covered the sites customers build

Interaction, visual, system

a query builder that had to stay honest about sampled data · a color engine with contrast held in light and dark · the token architecture that carries both

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Won the agency over to a change that costs them billable work — type size, spacing and radius moved into the token API, so product teams adjust them without a ticket.
- Standardization and flexibility, without trading one for the other — component and view tiers alias down to the primitives and add no new values, so a team moves without the foundation moving.
- Built for the people who are not designers — Storybook as the shared surface, and the token vocabulary handed to an AI assistant as a closed list rather than recalled.
- A prototyping layer on top of the real components — light and dark, phone through TV, so a product manager assembles a screen from the system instead of describing one.
- The build catches what a reviewer cannot — CI rejects a token reference that does not resolve and a color written in by hand. Neither shows up as a visual difference.
- Contrast decided by the algorithm, not by a later check — a color engine builds themes from program artwork with WCAG contrast validated inside it, so a theme that fails cannot ship.
- Screen-reader semantics and ARIA as standing practice — part of the work rather than a pass made before a release.
- Built Color Lab, the tool that tunes the color engine — thresholds, hue exclusion and the light and dark normalization curves are dials rather than commits, so tuning needs no engineer.
- Bet on light mode against the streaming default — the brand is warm, not cinema black. In validation 87% preferred it, at 4.2 out of 5 for premium feel (n=40).
- Kept a brand color out of the phone UI — the 2025 rebrand uses two text colors and the engine produces both. On a dense display the second tested as too much.
- Prototyped on the target platform, not the fast one — the gradients that looked right on web did not hold on Android, so I rebuilt the prototype there.
- Engineering ships from my prototype code — built in real code against production APIs, web first then Android, and the agency that ships it is not in my company.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Made an accessibility law survivable for the customers it landed on — churches run their websites on our platform, and the European Accessibility Act gave them a legal deadline.
- Shipped the capability that let them meet it automatically — six countries, under GDPR plus church data-protection law. The audit covered every site customers build with the platform.
- Built booking into the platform instead of bolting it on — the same build then carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings. At the launch customer, coordination time fell 70% and acceptance 90%.
- Held product management for the platform beside all of its design — which is why the booking architecture was mine to decide and mine to take to the customer.
- Designed the booking to offer only what was actually bookable — the rules of 20-plus cemeteries, buffer times and Outlook availability resolved before a slot appears, not after the click.
- Specified components so engineering never had to guess — interaction behavior written out, token-based naming, and redlined measurements in plain text beside the Figma file.
- Built the component set the reporting pages ran on — inline instant and advanced filters, and the image metadata modal, specified as system components rather than one-off page elements.
- Designed the booking system on web and on mobile — and engineering built the mobile side in React Native, across iOS and Android, from those designs.

Research and validation

Validation surveys against old and new designs · internal usability testing with follow-up interviews · iterative screening on usertesting.com to reach people inside regulated banks · Dovetail as a research repository · Claude over thousands of forum posts for sentiment and recurring pain points

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Owned the design system, and built the governance around it — a standing working group with engineering and four designers, with an escalation path, so decisions held after I left the room.
- Designed the components, not only the system around them — navigation, modals and the multi-select searchable dropdowns that a no-code platform needs on almost every screen.
- Motion in the design system, not per screen — custom easing curves, defined once. A B2B product carries far less motion than a consumer one, so it had to be shared.
- Ran design and product at the same time — for four months, nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Turned a services business into a product catalog — with the executive team of a listed group, and ran the design-thinking training for leadership.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved — what each one did, what it guaranteed and where it could be used, across the design system library.
- Built the components a data product actually needs — data table column headers and inspector panels, both specified in the design system library.
- The hardest interaction problem on the platform — big-data queries ran on samples, so a preview could show nothing while every matching row was there. I designed the feedback that said so.
- Five years of dense analytical interface work — column charts, big-data pivot tables, an aggregated JSON structure view, result cards and the filter system.
- One interface for business users, analysts and data engineers — the same screens had to serve people who never write a query and people who write nothing else.
- Got inside banks that let no vendor watch them work — executive-sponsored site visits, and iterative screening on usertesting.com to reach analysts the panels could not.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years, setting the design bar across both sites.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA